

Standard Operating Procedure

EntraPass Server & Software Setup — Baseline Checklist

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Related Documents	SOP-LV-010, SOP-LV-013
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Approved By	_____

NOTE ON THIS DOCUMENT:

EntraPass's exact menu structure, installer wizard steps, and licensing workflow differ meaningfully between Special Edition, Corporate Edition, and Global Edition, and between software versions. This SOP is a baseline planning and pre-installation checklist — it deliberately does not walk through specific EntraPass menu screens, since those change by edition/version and following stale menu steps risks missing a step entirely. For the actual step-by-step installer workflow, use the current EntraPass Administration Guide for the specific edition and version being installed.

1. Purpose

This procedure establishes a baseline pre-installation and setup checklist for EntraPass access control server software, to ensure server readiness and reduce install-day surprises.

2. Scope

Applies to Apex technicians installing or setting up EntraPass Special, Corporate, or Global Edition server software as part of a new access control deployment or major server migration.

3. Pre-Installation — Server Requirements

- Confirm the server meets Kantech's published minimum hardware and OS requirements for the specific EntraPass edition and version being installed — these change between versions; do not assume a spec that worked for a prior job still applies.
- Confirm whether the deployment is Special Edition, Corporate Edition, or Global Edition, and confirm the correct license has been purchased/is available before starting — edition determines both feature set and licensing model (see Section 5).
- For Global Edition specifically: confirm SQL Server requirements, since Global Edition's database architecture is heavier than Special/Corporate and has its own separate resource requirements.
- Confirm server network configuration in advance: static IP addressing plan, whether the server is virtualized, and how it will reach the controllers on site (see SOP-LV-013 for RS-485/controller-side network planning).

4. Pre-Installation — Environment Checks

- Confirm antivirus/firewall/Windows Defender exclusions will be configured for EntraPass processes and ports — unaddressed security software is a common, hard-to-diagnose cause of intermittent Gateway/controller communication problems after go-live (see TSW-LV-001, Section “G — EntraPass Global Edition / Server-Side” for the troubleshooting angle on this same issue).
- Confirm the server's date/time and time zone are correctly set before installation — access control event logging and scheduling depend on accurate system time.
- If migrating from a previous server or software edition, back up the existing database/configuration before beginning, and confirm the migration path (clean install + reconfigure, vs. migrated database/config) with the Site Supervisor — this decision affects post-migration troubleshooting significantly (see TSW-LV-001 for symptoms tied to migration issues).

5. Licensing

- Confirm the license covers the actual number of controllers/doors being deployed, including near-term planned expansion — under-licensing can cause controllers to be intermittently dropped from the system rather than failing cleanly, which is a confusing symptom to troubleshoot later.
- Record the license type, key/serial, and door/controller count on the site configuration sheet at the time of installation.

6. Gateway / Controller Communication Setup

- Confirm which gateway architecture applies to the deployment — Global Gateway, KT-NCC, or Multi-Site Gateway — and confirm it matches the intended site topology, not a default left over from a template.
- Compare Communication Timing settings (polling interval, timeout, retry) against the deployment's controller count and network conditions — default timing values are not automatically appropriate for every deployment size; a large controller count on one gateway may need adjusted timing (see TSW-LV-001 for the troubleshooting side of this).
- Confirm controller/door licensing, gateway assignment, and loop/RS-485 assignment match the actual physical installation before going live — verify against the site wiring reference (REF-AC-RS485-001 format), not from memory.

7. Post-Installation Verification

- Confirm every controller on site reports Online status in EntraPass before considering the installation complete.
- Confirm event messages are appearing correctly in the EntraPass message desktop for test activations (door open, REX, credential read).
- Confirm scheduled tasks, if configured (unlock schedules, holiday schedules), are set to the correct time zone and behave as expected on a test cycle.
- Document server specs, EntraPass edition/version, license details, and gateway configuration on the site commissioning file.

8. References

- Current Kantech EntraPass Administration Guide for the specific edition and version being installed (governs over this SOP for menu-level steps)
- SOP-LV-010 — KT-1/KT-2/KT-4/KT-400 Controller Default & Configuration
- SOP-LV-013 — RS-485 Bus Design & Installation
- TSW-LV-001 — RS-485 Communication Loop Troubleshooting Worksheet